Lesson plan · for the teacher

Spot a phishing message

Cyber safety · Level 1 · Lesson 2

Time
40 min

Materials
Board and chalk (or paper on the wall); 8 handwritten or printed message cards per group; Worksheet: Scam detective (one per pair, optional)

Learning goals

- Name five warning signs of a scam message.
- Sort printed messages into “scam” and “safe” and point to the warning sign.
- Explain how to check a message another way, such as asking a trusted adult.

Activity: Scam or safe?: Scam sort

1. Warm-up (5 min): Tell the gate story: a stranger says, “The head teacher sent me for the exam papers.” Ask pupils what they would do.
2. Teach (8 min): Explain phishing: a message that pretends to be someone you trust. Write the five warning signs on the board, each with a small drawing: clock, link, mask, key, gift.
3. Scam sort (14 min): Groups get eight message cards. They sort them into “scam” and “safe” piles and write the warning sign on each scam card. Walk around and ask groups to explain one choice.
4. Share (7 min): Each group reads one scam card aloud and says what they would do: stop, tell a trusted adult, check another way, then report and delete.
5. Wrap-up (6 min): Exit ticket: each pupil writes one warning sign and one safe action. Collect a few and read them out.

Write eight short messages on cards, four scams and four safe. Scams: a prize, an urgent fee, a request for a code, a link from an unknown number. Safe: a timetable, a sports reminder, a library notice, a parents’ meeting. Make one set per group.

Discussion

- Would you hand over the exam papers?
- How could you check whether the story is true?
- Which warning sign do you see?

Exit ticket

- One warning sign + what I would do if I saw it.

Try it in class tomorrow
Play “Scam or safe?”: Write six short messages on paper — three scams, three safe: a prize, a code request, an urgent fee, a timetable, a sports reminder, a library notice. Read each aloud. Pupils stand for “scam”, sit for “safe”, and name the warning sign.

Worksheet · for pupils

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **Which of these are warning signs of phishing?**

- ☐ "Reply within 24 hours or lose your account"
- ☐ A link you weren't expecting
- ☐ A request for your mobile money PIN
- ☐ Tomorrow's timetable from the school's saved number
- ☐ A message that greets you by name

2 **Scam messages are always full of spelling mistakes.**

○ True ○ False

3 **You tapped a link in a fake message and typed your email password. Put what to do next in order.**

- ☐ Report the message, then delete it
- ☐ Change it anywhere else you used it
- ☐ Change your email password right away
- ☐ Close the page and type nothing more

4 **A "colleague" texts from a new number: "My phone broke. Send me money by mobile money now — I'll pay you back tomorrow." What is the best first step?**

- ○ Send it — they promised to pay it back
- ○ Call your colleague on the number you already have
- ○ Reply and ask, "Is this really you?"

5 **Match each message to its warning sign.**

"Act now or lose your place"	• • • •	Sender doesn't match
"Read me the code we just sent"	• • • •	Too good to be true
"You've won a laptop!"	• • • •	Asks for a code
A "bank" on a personal number	• • • •	Urgency or a threat

✎ **Think of a scam message you, a colleague or a parent has received. Which warning sign gave it away — or would have?**